“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 15

The Divine Madness of Śrī Caitanya in Separation from Kṛṣṇa (continued)

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 In the unfathomable ocean of feelings for Kṛṣṇa, Gaurahari’s heart now sank and now rose; and so He revealed the greatness of *prema* in all its fullness.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the Supreme Lord! Glory to Nityānanda, whose body is full of bliss!

3 Glory to Advaitācārya, most dear to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Glory to Śrīvāsa and all the Lord’s devotees!

4 In this way, night and day, Mahāprabhu was so absorbed in love for Kṛṣṇa that He had no awareness of Himself.

5 Sometimes He was immersed in feeling, sometimes half aware of the outer world, sometimes fully aware of it: the Lord passed through these three states.

6 Bathing, going to see Lord Jagannātha and eating went on by the body’s own nature, as a potter’s wheel keeps turning by itself.

7 One day, when the Lord went to see Jagannātha, in Jagannātha He saw the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

8 At once the five qualities of Kṛṣṇa appeared to the Lord, and these five qualities drew His five senses.

9 The five qualities pulled His one mind in five directions, and in this tug-of-war the Lord's mind fell unconscious.

10 At that time Lord Jagannātha's *upala-bhoga* offering came to an end, and the devotees brought Mahāprabhu home.

11 With these two, Svarūpa and Rāmānanda, He lamented, His arms around their necks.

12 In separation from Kṛṣṇa, Rādhā's mind was restless with longing, and She told Viśākhā the cause of it.

13 Reciting that verse Himself, the Lord poured out the anguish of His heart, and lamenting, He explained its meaning to the two of them.

14 "O friend, with the waves of the nectar ocean of His beauty He floods the hills of women's hearts; His playful, charming words delight the ear; His body is cooler than millions of moons; with a flood of nectarean fragrance He covers the world; His lips are lovelier than nectar — that son of the king of the cowherds draws all five of My senses by force." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.3)

15 "Kṛṣṇa's form, His voice, His touch, His fragrance and the taste of His lips — their sweetness cannot be described. Seeing them, the five, in their greed, all mount one horse — My mind — and the five run off in five directions.

16 O friend, hear the cause of My sorrow. My five senses are utterly greedy robbers: they all say, ‘Steal another’s wealth!’

17 One horse, and at one moment the five pull it in five directions — which way is the one mind to run? When all pull at once, the horse’s life departs. I cannot bear this pain.

18 I am not angry with My senses — what fault is theirs? Kṛṣṇa’s form and the rest attract with great force. Form and the rest, the five, pull the five senses; the horse’s life departs, and life will not stay in My body.

19 The beauty of Kṛṣṇa is an ocean of nectar; a single drop of its waves drowns the world. The hearts of all the women in the three worlds are high mountains: it drowns them and surges on beyond.

20 The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa’s words, full of playful jests of every *rasa* — its injustice cannot be told. Entering the ears of the world’s women, it binds them with the rope of its sweetness and pulls; and in that tugging the ears’ very life departs.

21 Kṛṣṇa’s body is so cool — what can I say of its power? Its luster surpasses millions of moons and sandal. It is skilled at drawing the mountain-like breasts of women, and it draws their minds.

22 Kṛṣṇa’s body is full of fragrance; it humbles the pride of charming musk and robs the blue lotus of its wealth of pride. It makes its home in the nostrils of the women of the world and draws them to itself.

23 The nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s lips, with the camphor of His gentle smile, steals women’s minds by its own sweetness. It takes away all longing for anything else; not obtaining it, the mind is in turmoil. It is the chief wealth of the women of Vraja.”

24 Saying this, Gaurahari clasped the two by their necks and said, “Listen, Svarūpa and Rāmarāya: what shall I do, where shall I go? Where can I go to find Kṛṣṇa? Both of you, tell Me how!”

25 In this way, day after day, the Lord Gaura lamented with Svarūpa and Rāmānanda.

26 Those two consoled the Lord: Svarūpa sang songs, and Rāya recited verses.

27 With the verses and songs of the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*, of Vidyāpati and of the *Śrī Gīta-govinda* they gave the Lord joy.

28 One day, on His way to the sea, Mahāprabhu suddenly saw a flower garden.

29 Taking it for Vṛndāvana, He ran into it, and absorbed in *prema* He wandered there searching for Kṛṣṇa,

30 just as, when Kṛṣṇa disappeared from the *rāsa* dance taking Rādhā with Him, the *gopīs* afterwards wandered about searching for Him.

31 Absorbed in that mood, the Lord wandered here and there searching, reciting verse after verse to each tree and creeper:

32 “O *cūta*, *priyāla*, *panasa*, *āsana* and *kovidāra*, *jambu*, *arka*, *bilva*, *bakula*, mango, *kadamba* and *nīpa*, and all you other trees on the banks of the Yamunā, whose life is for the good of others — tell us, who have lost our very selves, which way Kṛṣṇa went!” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.9)

33 “O auspicious *tulasī*, dear to Govinda’s feet! Have you seen your most beloved Acyuta pass by, wearing you, with swarms of bees around Him?”

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.7)

34 “O *mālatī*, O *mallikā*, O *jāti*, O *yūthikā*! Have you seen Mādhava pass by, giving you joy with the touch of His hand?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.8)

35 “O mango, *panasa*, *piyāla*, *jambu* and *kovidāra*! You all dwell in a holy place — do good to others.

36 Did Kṛṣṇa come here to you? Did you see Him? Tell us where Kṛṣṇa is and save our lives!”

37 Receiving no answer, they reasoned again: “These are all male, like Kṛṣṇa’s friends.

38 Why would they tell us where Kṛṣṇa is? But these creepers are female, almost our friends.

39 They will surely tell us — they have seen Kṛṣṇa.” Reasoning thus, they questioned the *tulasī* and the other plants:

40 “O *tulasī*, *mālatī*, *yūthī*, *mādhavī* and *mallikā*! Did your beloved Kṛṣṇa come near you?

41 You are all like our friends. Tell us where Kṛṣṇa is, all of you, and save our lives!”

42 Receiving no answer, they thought within themselves: “These are Kṛṣṇa’s maidservants; out of fear they will not tell us.”

43 Ahead they saw some does, and catching the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa’s body, they looked at their faces and, now certain, questioned them:

44 “O friend, O doe, did Acyuta come this way with His beloved, delighting your eyes with the beauty of His limbs? For here blows the fragrance of our Lord’s *kunda* garland, colored with the *kuṅkuma* from His beloved’s breasts where it touched Her body.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.11)

45 “Tell us, O doe: did Śrī Kṛṣṇa come here with Rādhā to give you every joy? Do not tell us otherwise.

46 We are Rādhā’s dear friends, not outsiders; even from afar we know the fragrance of His body.

47 The air is scented with the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa’s *kunda* garland, adorned with *kuṅkuma* from Rādhā’s breasts where it touched Her body.

48 Kṛṣṇa has left this place, and she is pining in separation. What answer can she give? She does not even hear our words.”

49 Ahead they saw trees whose branches had all bent down to the earth under the weight of flowers and fruits.

50 Concluding that all these trees had bowed down on seeing Kṛṣṇa, they asked them, to be sure, which way He had gone:

51 “O trees, did Rāma’s younger brother pass this way, His arm on His beloved’s shoulder and a lotus in His hand, followed by swarms of bees blind with the intoxication of His *tulasī*? And as He passed, did He welcome your obeisances with loving glances?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.12)

52 As bees settled on His beloved’s face, He waved His pastime lotus to drive them away, and His mind was distracted.

53 Did He pay any attention to your obeisances, or did He not? Tell us, give us your word as proof.

54 These servants are grieving in separation from Kṛṣṇa. What answer can they give? They are not even conscious.”

55 Saying this, they went on to the bank of the Yamunā, and there they saw Kṛṣṇa beneath a *kadamba* tree.

56 He enchants millions of gods of love; the flute is at His lips; with His boundless beauty He steals the eyes and minds of the whole world.

57 Seeing that beauty, the Lord fell to the ground in a swoon. Just then Svarūpa and the others arrived and found Him.

58 As before, all the *sāttvika-bhāvas* appeared in all His limbs. Within He was tasting bliss; outwardly He was overwhelmed.

59 As before, they all together brought Him back to consciousness. Rising, the Lord looked all around.

60 “Where has Kṛṣṇa gone? I saw Him just now — Him whose beauty has stolen My eyes and mind!

61 Why do I not see Him again, with the flute at His lips? My eyes wander about, greedy to see Him.”

62 Then Mahāprabhu began to recite the verse that Rādhā had spoken to Viśākhā:

63 “O friend, His luster shines brighter than a new cloud; His garment is more charming than new lightning; His face, with the gleaming, beautiful flute, is like the full autumn moon; He is adorned with peacock feathers and

radiant with a lovely necklace shining like stars — that enchanter of Madana increases the longing of My eyes." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.4)

64 "Kṛṣṇa's complexion is glossy as a new cloud and smooth as ground collyrium; it puts the blue lotus to shame with its softness. Surpassing every comparison, Kṛṣṇa's luster is supremely powerful: it steals the eyes and minds of all.

65 Tell Me, O friend, what shall I do? Kṛṣṇa is a wondrous cloud, and the *cātaka* birds of My eyes, not seeing Him, are dying of thirst.

66 His yellow cloth is the lightning, never steady; His pearl necklace is a lovely row of cranes; His peacock feather is a rainbow appearing above, and His Vaijayantī garland is another rainbow.

67 Hearing the soft, sweet sound of His flute — the cloud's sweet thunder — the peacocks of Vṛndāvana dance. And in that cloud a wondrous moon is rising, spotless and full in all its digits, its moonlight of beauty sparkling.

68 With a shower of the nectar of His pastimes it drenches all fourteen worlds — but when such a cloud appeared, the storm wind of My misfortune carried it away to another place, and the *cātaka* is dying, for it could not drink."

69 Again He said, "Alas, alas! Recite, recite, Rāmarāya!" — so the Lord spoke, His voice choked with feeling. Rāmānanda recited a verse; hearing it, the Lord felt joy and sorrow, and He Himself explained it.

70 "Seeing Your face framed by curling locks and graced by the beauty of Your earrings, Your cheeks, the nectar of Your lips and Your smiling glance, and beholding Your two arms that grant fearlessness and Your chest, the sole delight of Śrī, we have become Your maidservants." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.29.39)

71 “Having conquered the lotus and the moon, Kṛṣṇa has set the snare of His face, baited with the sweet smile of His lips. The women of Vraja come, fall into the snare and become His maidservants, leaving shame, husbands, home and hearth.

72 Our friend Kṛṣṇa behaves like a hunter. He cares nothing for right or wrong; He steals the hearts of the women-does and devises many means to do it.

73 On His sparkling cheeks His *makara* earrings dance, and by that dance they steal the hearts of all women. With the arrows of His smiling sidelong glances He strikes their hearts, and He has no fear at all of killing women.

74 Kṛṣṇa’s chest — very high and broad, adorned with the marks of Lakṣmī and Śrīvatsa — is a robber: it is skilled at making the minds and breasts of hundreds of thousands of goddesses of Vraja into Hari’s maidservants.

75 Kṛṣṇa’s two arms are graceful long bolts — no, not arms, but the bodies of black snakes. They slip into the gap between the two hills and bite women’s hearts, and the women burn within from that poison.

76 The palms of Kṛṣṇa’s hands and the soles of His feet are cooler than millions of moons, surpassing camphor, vetiver root and sandal. A single touch of them destroys the burning poison of Smara, and their touch makes women’s minds greedy.”

77 Lamenting so much in His dejection, Śrī Gaurahari recited a verse with this meaning — the verse with which Rādhā spoke to Viśākhā, laying open the grief of Her heart:

78 “O friend, His broad chest outshines a door of sapphire; His bolt-like arms take away the distress of young girls’ minds tormented by Smara; His

body is cooler than the moon, *hari-candana*, the lotus and camphor — that enchanter of Madana increases the longing of My breast." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.7)

79 The Lord said, "I saw Kṛṣṇa just now, and by My own misfortune I have lost Him again.

80 Kṛṣṇa is fickle by nature; He does not stay in one place. He shows Himself, steals the mind and disappears."

81 "Seeing the *gopīs*' pride in their good fortune and their self-esteem, Keśava, to calm it and to show them grace, disappeared right there." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.29.48)

82 He said to Svarūpa Gosāñi, "Sing a song that will bring My heart back to awareness."

83 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi sweetly sang for the Lord a song from the *Gīta-govinda*:

84 "My mind remembers Hari, who here in the *rāsa* dance enjoyed His pastimes and His jests." (Gīta-govinda, 2.3)

85 When Svarūpa Gosāñi sang this song, the Lord rose, absorbed in *prema*, and began to dance.

86 The eight *sāttvika-bhāvas* appeared in His body, and all the *vyabhicārī-bhāvas*, beginning with joy, welled up.

87 Feelings arose (*bhāvodaya*), met (*bhāva-sandhi*) and mingled (*bhāva-śābalya*); feeling fought feeling in a great battle, each striving to prevail.

88 Again and again He had that song sung; again and again He relished it and danced.

89 When the dancing had gone on in this way for a long time, Svarūpa Gosāñi brought the song to a close.

90 “Sing! Sing!” the Lord said again and again, but seeing His fatigue, Svarūpa Gosāñi did not sing.

91 The Lord kept saying, “Sing! Sing!” Hearing this, the devotees gathered all around and called out the name of Hari.

92 Then Rāmānanda Rāya made the Lord sit down and relieved His fatigue by fanning Him and serving Him in other ways.

93 Then they took the Lord to the seashore, bathed Him, and brought Him home again.

94 They gave the Lord His meal and had Him lie down to rest, and Rāmānanda and all the others went to their own places.

95 Thus I have told of the Lord’s pastime in the garden that He entered, taking it for Vṛndāvana.

96 This description of His madness, together with His lament, Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi has also written:

97 “On the shore of the ocean, at the sight of rows of gleaming gardens, He remembered again and again the forest of Vṛndāvana and was overwhelmed by the *prema* it awakened; and at times His tongue moved restlessly, repeating Kṛṣṇa’s name. Will that Caitanya, the relisher of *bhakti*, come once again before my eyes?” (Stava-mālā, First Caitanyāṣṭaka, 6)

98 Śrī Caitanya’s pastimes are endless; they cannot all be written. I only point the way and give a hint of them.

99 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.